Local SEO Masterclass

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Ranking a Local Google ...

Introduction to Local SEO

NAP Consistency + Map Emb...

Getting ONLY 5 Star Reviews f...

Getting a Google My Busines...

GMB Location + Direction Ma...

Rank and Rent (Organic S...

Introduction to Rank and Rents

Setting up a Rank and Rent

Ranking your Rank and Rent

Pricing your Rank and Rent

Pitching Rank and Rents

Local SEO for Beginners (...

Module 1: Introduction to Loc...

Module 2: Setting Up Your Go...

Module 12: Setting Up Analytics and Tracking

Overview: With many optimizations underway, tracking the outcomes is crucial. This module covers how to set up **Google Analytics (GA)** and **Google Search Console (GSC)** to monitor your website's traffic and search performance. We'll guide you through configuring these free tools and highlight key metrics to watch (like organic traffic growth, conversion actions, and search queries driving traffic). For an agency, being able to measure and report on progress is vital. By the end of this module, you'll have the tools in place to see exactly how your SEO efforts are paying off and to catch any issues early (like traffic drops or site errors).

Lessons:

1. **Why Analytics Matter:** We explain that one advantage of digital marketing is the ability to track everything. Setting up analytics allows you to see if your SEO work is resulting in more visitors and leads. We also caution that SEO is a gradual process, so you may not see huge spikes immediately, but trends over months are important. Analytics data will help you make informed decisions and show clients tangible results (e.g., "Organic traffic increased 30% this quarter").
2. **Google Analytics Setup (GA4):** Since Universal Analytics

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account, a property for the website, and installing the tracking code on the site. We suggest using Google Tag Manager or a CMS plugin if that simplifies installation. We highlight key GA4 features like tracking page views, user demographics, and setting up conversion goals (like a contact form submission or click-to-call as a goal). Once

Module 3: Expanding Presenc…

Module 4: Local Keyword Res…

Module 5: On-Page SEO for Y…

Module 6: Local Business Sch…

Module 7: Key Local SEO Ran…

Module 8: Building Citations

Module 9: Advanced Google …

Module 10: Online Reviews & …

Module 11: Local Link Buildin…

Module 12: Setting Up Analyti…

Module 13: Conducting a Loc…

Module 14: Competitor SEO A…

Module 15: Tracking and Rep…

Module 16: Bringing It All Tog…

GA is installed, you'll start collecting data on how many people visit, how they found the site, and what pages they engage with.

3. **Google Search Console Setup:** Next, we walk through **Google Search Console** – which is essential for SEO. Steps include adding the site as a property in GSC and verifying ownership (using the GA verification method or uploading an HTML file or DNS record). GSC will show you which search queries your site appears for, your average rankings, click-through rates, and if Google has any crawl issues or indexing problems. We emphasize how GSC can alert you to errors like broken pages or security issues, so it's a must-have tool.

4. **Key Metrics to Monitor:** Once both tools run, we teach which metrics to pay attention to for local SEO. In Google Analytics: look at **Acquisition > Traffic channels > Organic Search** to see organic traffic over time. Also check **Geo/Location** to ensure you're attracting visitors from the desired local area. In Search Console: review the **Performance** report to see top queries (keywords) that are bringing impressions and clicks. Look at the **coverage** report to ensure all pages are indexed without errors, and check the **core web vitals** for site performance. We also mention setting up **Goals or Conversions** in GA (like contact form completions or phone number clicks) – so you can measure leads, not just visits.

5. **Regular Reporting and Analysis:** Finally, we suggest establishing a routine for analysis. For instance, at the end of each month, pull key numbers: how many organic users, how many conversions (calls, forms) from organic, any improvement in Google search impressions or average ranking. We talk about looking at year-over-year data (to account for seasonality) when you have it. If something is



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update? etc.). On the flip side, celebrate wins – e.g., a specific keyword moved from page 2 to page 1 and now brings traffic. Being data-driven will help you refine your strategy (for example, if Search Console shows a keyword you didn't target much but it's appearing, you might optimize for it and get more traffic).

Implementation Steps:

- **Sign Up for Google Analytics:** Go to analytics.google.com and create an account for your client (or your agency, then a property for the client's site). Follow the prompts to set up a GA4 property. When asked, enter the website name, URL, industry, time zone, etc. GA4 will then give you a "Measurement ID" (format G-XXXXXXXX).
- **Install GA Tracking Code:** In GA, navigate to "Data Streams" > Web and get the JavaScript snippet or use the measurement ID with a plugin. Insert this code into the `<head>` of every page on the site (if using WordPress, plugins like Google Site Kit or Insert Headers and Footers can help). If done correctly, GA will start tracking. You can test by going to your site and then checking GA's real-time report to see if your visit registers.
- **Create a Conversion Goal (if applicable):** In GA4, events track conversions. E.g., if you have a "Thank You" page after a contact form, ensure GA is recording page_view for that page and mark that event as a conversion. Or set up an event for phone link clicks. This might need some setup or use of Google Tag Manager, but even without advanced goals, GA will still be collecting basic data.
- **Set Up Google Search Console:** Visit search.google.com/search-console. Log in with the same Google account. Click "Add Property" and choose URL prefix (enter the exact site URL) or domain level. The easiest verify method: if you used the same account for GA, you can verify via GA (GSC will detect GA code on the site). Alternatively, download and upload the HTML verification file to the website's root folder, then click verify. Once done, Google will start showing search data (it may take a day or two to populate initial data).



pages are indexed or if any are excluded/errors. Fix any glaring issues (like a page being blocked by robots.txt unintentionally). Also submit a sitemap if you have one (XML sitemap link can be provided to GSC to help crawling). In Analytics, after a week or so, see how many users came

via organic search and what pages they looked at. This is your baseline to improve upon.

- **Schedule Reporting:** Decide on a reporting frequency (monthly is common for clients). Create a simple report or dashboard. It might include: total organic visits this period vs last, top 5 pages by organic traffic, number of conversions from organic, and any noteworthy changes in rankings (you can get some of that from GSC's performance by filtering queries). You can use tools like Google Data Studio to build a nice report or even export CSVs from GA/GSC to make charts. The key is to consistently measure so you can correlate improvements (for example, after building citations and links, you should eventually see more impressions/clicks in Search Console for local queries – that's proof of success!).

Milestone: *By the end of Module 12, you will have Google Analytics and Search Console fully set up and collecting data for the website.* The milestone achievement is tracking **your SEO progress** – you'll have baseline metrics (current organic traffic levels, current keyword rankings/impressions, etc.) and a system to monitor growth. With real data, you can confidently answer questions like "How are we doing in Google?". This is crucial for your SEO agency ambitions: clients want to see numbers. With GA and GSC, you can show how your efforts translate into more visitors and hopefully more leads/sales, closing the loop on the local SEO campaign.